CITY OF WALNUT CREEK

Agenda Item Number 5b

Agenda Report

Date: October 6, 2026

To: City Council

From: City Manager's Office

Subject: Consideration of Resolutions Supporting and Endorsing Measure W, Measure T, Measure RTM, and Proposition 1 on the November 3, 2026 Ballot

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Statement of Issue

The City Council is being asked to consider whether to express support for and endorse each of the following ballot measures appearing on the November 3, 2026 ballot: Measure W, Measure T, Measure RTM, and Proposition 1.

Discussion

At the City Council meeting on September 15, 2026, City Council requested an agendized item at its next regular meeting to consider expressing formal support for and endorsement of local ballot measures, including Measure W, Measure T, and Measure RTM. Additionally, the League of California Cities requested that cities consider supporting Proposition 1 on the November 3, 2026 statewide ballot. The Legislative Committee reviewed this request and authorized staff to include an item for City Council to consider support of Proposition 1 alongside its consideration of Measures W, T, and RTM.

The subsections below describe each of the four November 3, 2026 ballot measures City Council is asked to consider.

Measure W

Measure W is a local parcel tax measure proposed by the Acalanes Union High School District (AUHSD) seeking voter authorization of AUHSD's funding proposal to levy a parcel tax of $168 for eight years to support high-quality education in local high schools. AUHSD serves students in

grades 9 through 12 in Walnut Creek, Lafayette, Moraga, and Orinda and operates four comprehensive, high-performing public high schools – Las Lomas, Acalanes, Campolindo, and Miramonte – as well as the Acalanes Center for Independent Study. AUHSD relies on local funding measures and education foundations to supplement state funding, and its local parcel tax has not increased in 16 years. As a result, AUHSD has absorbed over $4 million in budget cuts over the past two years that have impacted student electives, library and counseling services, and enrichment programs. Without a new and sustainable source of additional funding, further reductions and budget cuts are likely.

If approved by voters, Measure W would generate approximately $6 million annually in locally controlled funding for AUHSD to maintain the quality of its teaching, learning, and classroom instruction by attracting and retaining highly qualified teachers; continuing advanced academic programs in science, technology, engineering, math, and arts that prepare students for success in college and careers; and maintaining manageable class sizes. Funds generated by Measure W cannot, by law, be taken by the state. The proposed measure would also require independent audits and the establishment of a Citizens' Oversight Committee to ensure funds are spent properly. The Measure W parcel tax measure also includes exemptions for eligible seniors and persons receiving Supplemental Security Income and Social Security Disability Insurance regardless of age.

A "yes" vote on Measure W supports AUHSD's parcel tax funding proposal, and a "no" vote rejects the proposal. Measure W requires approval by two-thirds (66.67%) of voters to pass, and all registered voters residing within AUHSD boundaries are eligible to vote on this measure.

Adoption of the attached draft resolution (Attachment 1) would formally express the City Council's support for and endorsement of the AUHSD's Measure W parcel tax.

Measure T

Measure T is a local ballot measure seeking voter authorization to change the Walnut Creek City Treasurer from an elected to an appointed City Treasurer. The City Council voted unanimously on May 19, 2026 to place Measure T on the November 3, 2026 ballot.

The Walnut Creek City Treasurer is currently a locally elected position established pursuant to California Government Code 36501. The City Treasurer is responsible for oversight of the City of Walnut Creek's financial assets, including cash management, investments, financial reporting, and other key activities. However, the responsibilities of this vital city role in recent years have expanded and become more complex, including overseeing over $100 million in municipal investments and requiring expert knowledge in public finance, accounting, and government

finance compliance laws. Meanwhile, the current requirement to hold this position is being a Walnut Creek registered voter and being elected by the voters. Changing from an elected to an appointed City Treasurer would bring Walnut Creek into alignment with municipal practices and over 90% of cities across the state that today employ appointed (not elected) City Treasurers.

A “yes” vote on Measure T is a vote in favor of making the proposed change from an elected Walnut Creek City Treasurer to an appointed City Treasurer, and a “no” vote is a vote to reject the proposed change. Measure T requires approval by a majority of voters (50% + 1 voters) to pass, and all registered voters residing within incorporated City of Walnut Creek are eligible to vote on this measure.

Adoption of the attached draft resolution (Attachment 2) would formally express the City Council’s support for and endorsement of the Measure T City Treasurer Measure.

Measure RTM

Measure RTM, also known as the Regional Transit Measure or Connect Bay Area Transit Initiative, is a five-county regional ballot measure for transportation funding that was authorized to be placed on the November 3, 2026 ballot in Contra Costa, Alameda, San Mateo, Santa Clara, and San Francisco counties when Senate Bill 63 (Wiener/Arreguín), the Connect Bay Area Act, was enacted in 2025. Measure RTM is seeking voter authorization to enact a 0.5% sales tax in Contra Costa, Alameda, San Mateo, and Santa Clara counties and a 1% sales tax in San Francisco County for 14 years to fund and avert major service cuts to San Francisco Bay Area transit operators and agencies facing fiscal cliffs.

If approved by voters, the proposed measure would generate approximately $980 million annually across the five counties for improvements to transit safety, cleanliness, affordability, and reliability. Measure RTM sales tax revenues would be dedicated to maintaining transit operations for numerous regional transit operators and agencies, including Bay Area Rapid Transit (BART), San Francisco Municipal Transportation Agency, Caltrain, Alameda-Contra Costa Transit District, and other agencies. Revenues would also be distributed to county transportation agencies, including the Contra Costa Transportation Authority, for public transit expenses and roadway repaving projects on roads served by fixed-route transit, such as bus routes. The proposed Measure RTM also establishes requirements for financial transparency, oversight, and accountability, including an independent oversight committee, an ad hoc adjudication committee, and third-party review of the four largest operators to reduce costs without compromising service.

A “yes” vote on Measure RTM supports enacting the new Regional Transit Measure sales tax funding proposal, and a “no” vote opposes the funding proposal. Measure RTM requires approval by a majority of voters (50% + 1 voters) to pass, and all registered voters residing within Contra Costa, Alameda, San Mateo, Santa Clara, and San Francisco counties are eligible to vote on this measure.

Adoption of the attached draft resolution (Attachment 3) would formally express the City Council’s support for and endorsement of the Measure RTM Regional Transit Measure.

Proposition 1

Proposition 1, the Veterans and Affordable Housing Bond Act of 2026, is a statewide ballot measure that would authorize $11.25 billion in general obligation bonds to fund the development, preservation, and rehabilitation of affordable housing projects, including $1.25 billion in bonds for veteran home loan and housing programs.

Housing affordability and homelessness are critical issues in California today, and funding remains a key barrier to developing affordable housing. The investments proposed in Proposition 1 provide critical funding to support infill infrastructure programs necessary for the development of new housing, help meet affordable housing components of Regional Housing Needs Allocation, and provide $200 million for local pilot programs like regional housing trusts. If approved by the voters, Proposition 1 would replenish funding for several successful state programs, including:

- Multifamily Housing Program
- Infill Infrastructure Grant Program
- CalHome Program
- Farmworker Housing
- Tribal Housing Grant Program
- Higher Education student housing
- Local pilot programs
- Veterans’ Housing

The state would repay the bond – the largest such bond since 2018 – through its General Fund and veterans’ payments on their home loans.

A “yes” vote on Proposition 1 supports authorizing the Veterans and Affordable Housing Bond Act of 2026, and a “no” vote opposes the bond issue. Proposition 1 requires approval by a majority of voters (50% + 1 voters) to pass, and all registered voters in California are eligible to vote on this measure.

Adoption of the attached draft resolution (Attachment 4) would formally express the City Council's support for and endorsement of Proposition 1, the Veterans and Affordable Housing Bond Act of 2026.

Financial Impacts

There are no financial impacts that would result from adoption of any of the draft resolutions.

Alternative Action

The City Council may choose not to adopt any or all of the resolutions or may choose to amend the language of any or all of the resolutions.

Attachments

Attachment 1:	Draft Resolution Declaring Support for Measure W
Attachment 2:	Draft Resolution Declaring Support for Measure T
Attachment 3:	Draft Resolution Declaring Support for Measure RTM
Attachment 4:	Draft Resolution Declaring Support for Proposition 1

City Council Action Recommended

Consider declaring City Council support for and endorsement of Measure W, Measure T, Measure RTM, and Proposition 1.

Staff Contact

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